

Web Development (Introduction)

WEDE5020 PART 1

ST10436896

PART 1: BUILDING THE FOUNDATION

GradLink Hub: Connecting Students to Opportunities

Introduction

A professionally developed web site in the modern digital economy is a key to the organisations that want to grow and be competitive. A site also serves as an online platform between an organisation and its stakeholders and allows communication, service delivery and positioning of the brand at an international level. Studies show that about three-quarters of users consider the credibility of a company in the design of its sites (Stanford University, 2023). Moreover, websites enable organisations to work 24/7 as they do not have geographical restrictions on the provision of services (Chaffey and Ellis-Chadwick, 2019). The current project is targeted at the development of the GradLink Hub, a user-friendly web-based application that will help resolve the issue of graduate unemployment in South Africa by matching students and graduates with job opportunities, mentoring, and career growth opportunities.

Website Goals and Objectives

Primary Goals:

- Close the education-employment gap.
- Increase graduate employability in South Africa
- Offer available career development resources.
- Link employers to talented aspirants.

SMART Objectives:

- Grow registered users by 30 percent in 6 months.
- Make at least 500 job applications monthly.
- Keep engagement among users at more than 60 percent.

- Decrease bounce rate by less than 40%.

Key Performance Indicators (KPIs):

- Website traffic growth
- Conversion rate
- Average session duration
- User retention rate
- The employment rate of the job placement.

Current Website Analysis

- LinkedIn
- Strong professional networking
- Not student-focused
- Indeed
- Extensive job listings
- Limited career tools
- Glassdoor
- Company insights
- Limited student features

GITHUB REPOSITORY

Includes:

- HTML files

- CSS & JS
- README.md

README Contains:

- Project overview
- Features
- Timeline
- References

Suggested Features and Functionalities.

- Job portal with filtering and tracking of applications.
- A skills development center and CV builder.
- Connections: Mentorship system with matching and chat.
- Career resources such as interview preparation.
- User authentication system

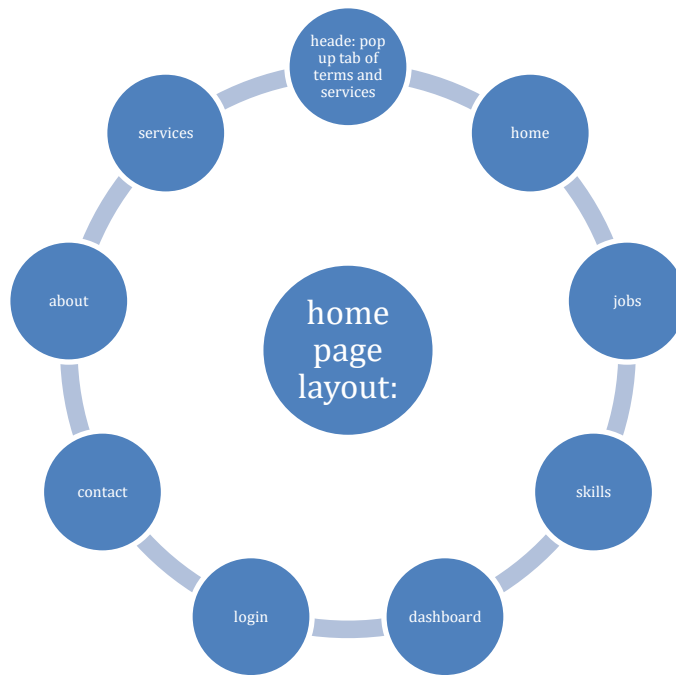
Proposal 2: SneakyKicks

An e-commerce and branding sneaker stores. Although a viable idea, it is less scholarly and socially impactful compared to GradLink Hub.

Design Aesthetic and UX.

- Colours: Lime green, black, white, navy blue
- Typography: Poppins (headings), Roboto (body)
- UX: Mobile-first, intuitive navigation
- Accessibility: WCAG compliance, alt text, keyboard navigation

Wireframes:



Jobs Page Layout:

- Search box, Filters, Job listings, Pagination.
- Technical Requirements
- Technologies: JavaScript, CSS3, HTML5.
- Technologies: VS Code, GitHub.
- Performance: Responsive design, optimised images.
- SEO: Meta-tags, headings, keywords.

Project Timeline

- Week 1: Planning
- Week 2: HTML
- Week 3: CSS
- Week 4: JavaScript
- Week 5: Testing

Budget

- Domain: R150/year
- Hosting: R100/month
- Development: R5000
- Tools: Free

Proposals

Proposal 1: GradLink Hub - Student employment hub.

Proposal 2: SneakyKicks - Sneaker e-commerce platform

Content Research and Sourcing.

Sources would be scholarly and industry websites.

Copyright and appropriate attribution are some legal considerations.

File Structure

GradLink-hub/

index.html

jobs.html

skills.html

css/

js/

images/

Sitemap

Home page > Jobs > Skills > Mentorship > Career Tools > Sign Up.

GitHub Requirements

Repository contains HTML, CSS, JS, README, and changelog.

Conclusion

This project forms a good base in a platform that deals with graduate unemployment whilst adhering to the best web development practices.

References

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